

Class XII English – Key Words & Elements for Exam Preparation

The Last Lesson

- Franz – reluctant student, realizes value of mother tongue
- M. Hamel – dedicated teacher, symbolizes patriotism
- Theme – importance of language, sense of loss
- Prussian occupation, German imposed
- Emotional atmosphere, church bell, pigeons = freedom

Deep Water

- William Douglas – narrator
- Childhood fear at YMCA pool
- Near-drowning experience, paralyzing terror
- Resolution, courage, hired instructor
- Theme – willpower, determination, conquering fear

Lost Spring

- Anees Jung – author
- Stories of poor children – Saheb (ragpicker), Mukesh (bangle maker)
- Theme – child labour, poverty, lost childhood
- Saheb – dream of school, tennis shoes
- Mukesh – wants to become motor mechanic

The Rattrap

- Selma Lagerlöf – author
- Peddler – poor, sells rattraps
- Philosophy – world is a rattrap

- Events at Crofter's house, ironmaster's house, Edla's compassion
- Transformation of peddler – redemption, human goodness

Indigo

- Mahatma Gandhi – Champaran episode
- Exploitation of peasants by British landlords
- Rajkumar Shukla – determined peasant
- Civil disobedience, non-violent resistance
- Theme – self-reliance, courage, first triumph of truth and justice

The Third Level

- Jack Finney – author
- Charley – protagonist, escapist tendency
- Grand Central – third level, 1890s setting
- Galesburg – symbol of peace, security
- Theme – escapism vs. harsh reality, need for comfort

The Tiger King

- Kalki – author
- Astrologer's prediction – death by tiger
- King kills 99 tigers, fate fulfilled by wooden toy tiger
- Satire on arrogance of power, futility of human effort
- Theme – destiny, irony, superstition

Journey to the End of the Earth

- Tishani Doshi – author
- Antarctica – pristine, isolated continent
- Students on Ice programme
- Lessons of climate change, interconnectedness of ecosystems

- Theme – ecological awareness, urgent need for conservation